AI Power in Marketing

In my conversations with hundreds of business leaders, one thing has become clear: AI has become the silent engine powering modern marketing in India, transforming everything from campaign automation and copywriting to audience targeting and real-time analytics.

TAKEAWAYS

- **AI is powering marketing in India, transforming all, be it campaign automation or audience targeting**
- **With AI, Indian creators are setting trends and redefining what's possible in digital storytelling**
- **As firms race to build AI products, they will depend on Indian talent for research, design, deployment and scaling**

No longer limited by manual processes, marketers are embracing a faster, more iterative and data-driven creative workflow. This isn't a distant promise—it's the new reality across agencies, startups and global brands, with AI now an indispensable, if often invisible, collaborator in every campaign.

And we're seeing the impact of this on our platforms too. Not only do nearly all advertisers on Meta platforms use AI-powered ad tools known as Advantage+ to automate their campaigns, but research studies have also shown that returns to personalised advertising on our platforms increase by 25 per cent when advertisers in India leverage AI tools to augment targeting.

Over this past year, another thing has become clear: AI is not replacing marketers. Instead, it is elevating them. Indian marketing teams are discovering that AI removes the grunt work, freeing them to focus on what truly matters—strategy, storytelling and understanding human emotion.

There is understandable anxiety around AI's impact on creativity. But what we're witnessing is not a displacement of human expression; it's an expansion of it. With AI as a creative partner, Indian creators are setting trends and redefining what's possible in digital storytelling and self-expression. Take the example of the AI-enabled snow effect via the Restyle tool in the Edits app, which went viral in India in November. Weekly new Edits users in India doubled in that week compared to the previous one.

AI allows ideas to move from mind to draft at unprecedented speed with powerful text, image and video generation tools. India's creative community is embracing this shift in a distinctly Indian way—mixing tradition with innovation.

MANY INDIAN AI STARTUPS ARE NOT SIMPLY FOLLOWING GLOBAL TRENDS **BUT BUILDING INDIA-FIRST SOLUTIONS**

We recently announced that you will soon be able to use Meta AI to translate Reels in five new Indian languages, helping you discover more entertaining content from across India and around the world. Earlier this year, we launched the ability for creators to dub and lip-sync their reels to and from English, Hindi, Spanish and Portuguese, helping them reach more people globally. And now, the same capability will be available in Bengali, Tamil, Telugu, Kannada and Marathi. Instead of making creativity generic, AI is making it more accessible.

The World's AI Engine

If marketing and creativity show how AI is changing outputs, India's developer community shows how it is changing capabilities. India already has one of the world's largest pools of developers, and AI is accelerating their evolution even further. But the real transformation lies deeper: AI is enabling developers to become problem-solvers rather than just coders.

This shift positions India to lead the global AI revolution. As companies worldwide race to build AI products, they will increasingly rely on Indian talent not just for development, but for end-to-end innovation—research, design, deployment and scaling.

AI startups in India are already growing at an unprecedented rate, pushing innovation in healthcare, finance, education, agriculture, logistics and climate technology. Many of these startups are not simply following global trends, they are building India-first solutions that the world can learn from.

Take the example of Ekatra transforming last-mile education by delivering personalised, bite-sized learning directly on WhatsApp—meeting learners where they already are. Powered by Llama's open-source AI models, its conversational AI tutor adapts content in real time across languages, contexts and connectivity constraints. This WhatsApp-first, Llama-powered approach has enabled high engagement and completion, reaching over 35,000 learners across underserved communities globally with minimal data and infrastructure.

As we head toward 2026, the debate about whether AI will change the world feels outdated. It already has. The real question now is: how will we use it to shape the world in the AI era?

AI grew up this year. And India emerged as the place where the world's AI future will be built—not because machines are replacing people, but because AI is placing the power of technology in the hands of hundreds of millions of people. And it is only just the beginning. ■

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